



Incident report analysis

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this chart as a way to practice applying the NIST framework to different situations you encounter.

Summary	The organization experienced a Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) attack that disrupted internal network operations for approximately two hours. The attack was caused by a flood of ICMP packets entering the network through an improperly configured firewall. The excessive traffic overwhelmed network resources and prevented legitimate users from accessing critical services. The incident response team mitigated the attack by blocking incoming ICMP traffic, taking non-critical services offline, and restoring critical network operations. Following the investigation, additional security controls were implemented to reduce the likelihood of future attacks.
Identify	The incident was identified as an ICMP Flood Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) attack. The attack targeted the organization's internal network infrastructure and network services. Investigation revealed that an unconfigured firewall allowed malicious ICMP traffic to enter the network. The affected systems included internal network resources, network services, firewall infrastructure, and users who were unable to access organizational services during the attack.
Protect	To better protect organizational assets, firewall configurations should be reviewed regularly and updated to restrict unnecessary ICMP traffic. Rate-limiting rules should remain in place to prevent excessive packet volumes from

	overwhelming systems. Source IP verification should be enforced to reduce the risk of spoofed traffic. Security awareness training and regular network security audits should also be conducted to identify configuration weaknesses before they can be exploited.
Detect	The organization should continuously monitor network traffic using network monitoring software, intrusion detection systems (IDS), and security information and event management (SIEM) tools. Automated alerts should be configured to identify unusual traffic spikes, excessive ICMP requests, and suspicious network behavior. Regular review of firewall logs and IDS alerts will help security teams detect future attacks more quickly.
Respond	If a similar incident occurs, the security team should immediately identify affected systems, block malicious traffic, isolate impacted resources if necessary, and activate the incident response plan. Firewall logs, IDS alerts, and network traffic captures should be collected and analyzed to determine the source and scope of the attack. Communication procedures should be followed to notify management and relevant stakeholders. Lessons learned should be documented to improve future response efforts.
Recover	Critical network services should be restored according to established recovery procedures. Network devices and firewall configurations should be validated before returning systems to full operation. Backup configurations should be maintained to support rapid recovery if future incidents occur. Recovery activities should include testing systems for normal functionality, monitoring for additional malicious activity, and documenting improvements to strengthen organizational resilience.

Reflections/Notes: This incident demonstrated the importance of proper firewall configuration,

continuous network monitoring, and layered security controls. Applying the NIST Cybersecurity organize the response and identify opportunities for improving the organization's the organization's security posture.